

Within the figure Newton inscribes the parallelograms Ab , Bc , Cd , each raised on one of the equal bases and reaching upward only to the lower vertex of the curve on that base. Because each inscribed rectangle stops short of the curve, their united area — the step-figure $AKbLcMdD$ — lies entirely below it. Thus the inscribed figure is a deficient approximation, always less than the true curvilinear area.